STAFF GUIDE · AJG (ASSEMBLYMEMBER JESSE GABRIEL) PRESS COVERAGE

Updating the tracker with the Update station

How to find new stories about Jesse Gabriel and save them into the PC tracker, from start to finish.

How the job works

New stories reach the tracker in a loop that moves between your PC and a page on claude.ai called the **Update station**. The PC tells the station what the tracker already has; the station searches for what is new and hands back one zip file; the PC checks it and saves it.

Step	Where	What happens
1. Make the “for Update” file	PC tracker	A small file listing the stories the tracker already has.
2. Load it into the station	Update station	The station now knows what not to find again, and from which date to search.
3. Update database	Update station	Searches the web for new stories. About 25 minutes.
4. Add PDFs (optional)	Update station	NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, for stories the web search can’t reach.
5. Download the update folder	Update station	One .zip file with everything found.
6. Bring in update and Save	PC tracker	The tracker shows what it would change; you press Save.
7. Make refresh files	PC tracker	So your colleagues’ copies match yours.

Before you start

1. **Use the keeper copy** of the PC tracker. Only the keeper saves updates. (The companion guide, *Using the AJG Press Tracker*, explains keeper and reader copies.)
2. **Close Excel** if the workbook is open.
3. **Have the Update station link ready:**

   Open the Update station

   https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL

4. **Allow Claude and TinyFish for the station page** the first time (see “If something is blocked” in the station’s How it works). TinyFish is the free web search the station uses.

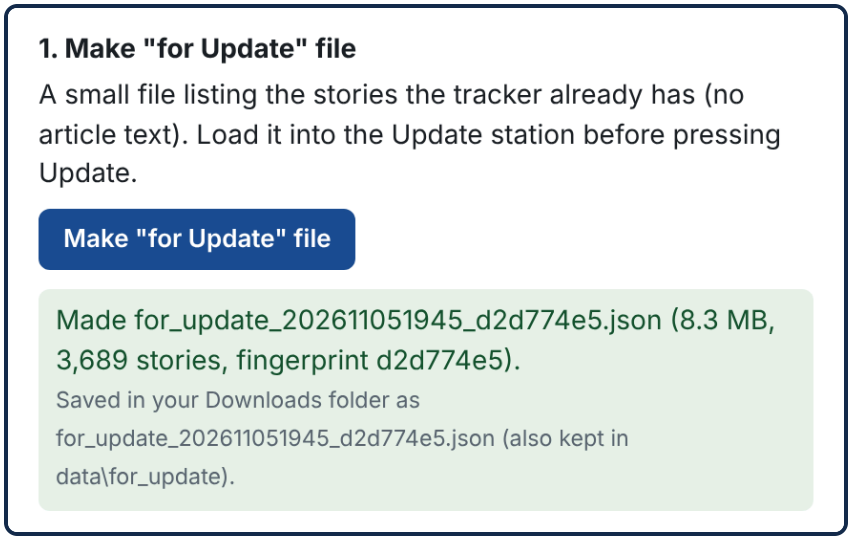
Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC

The Update station never changes your workbook. It only makes a zip file. The PC tracker shows you everything in the zip before it saves, and backs up the workbook first.

STEP 1 · ON THE PC

Make the “for Update” file

1. Start the tracker (double-click `Start Tracker.cmd`).
2. Click **Tracker files** at the top right.
3. Under **1. Make “for Update” file**, click the button. It takes about a minute.
4. The file downloads to your Downloads folder, named like `for_update_202611051945_d2d774e5.json`: the date and time it was made, then the workbook’s fingerprint (a short code that changes whenever the workbook changes).



The file was made and downloaded.

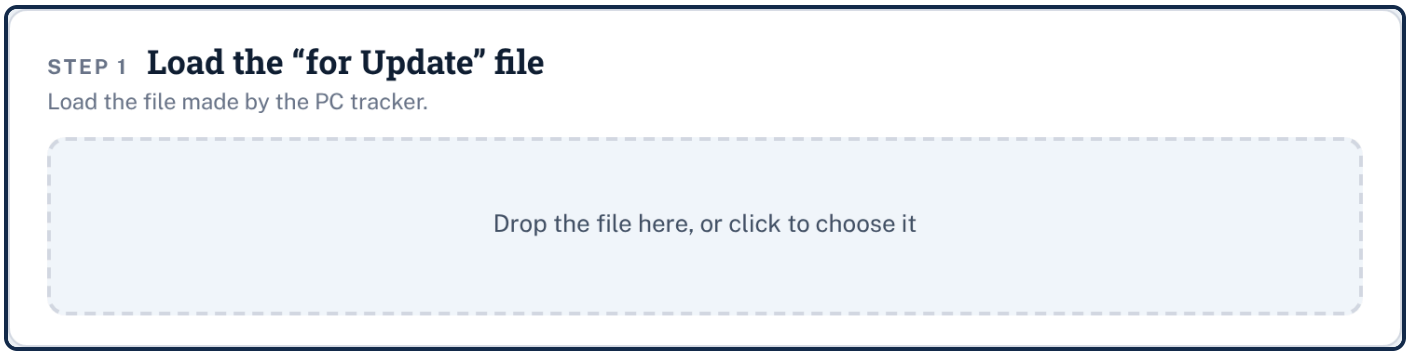
MAKE A NEW ONE AFTER EVERY SAVE

The file lists the stories the tracker has right now. A file made before a save doesn’t know about the stories that save added, so the station would find them again. The file holds no article text and is not stored online.

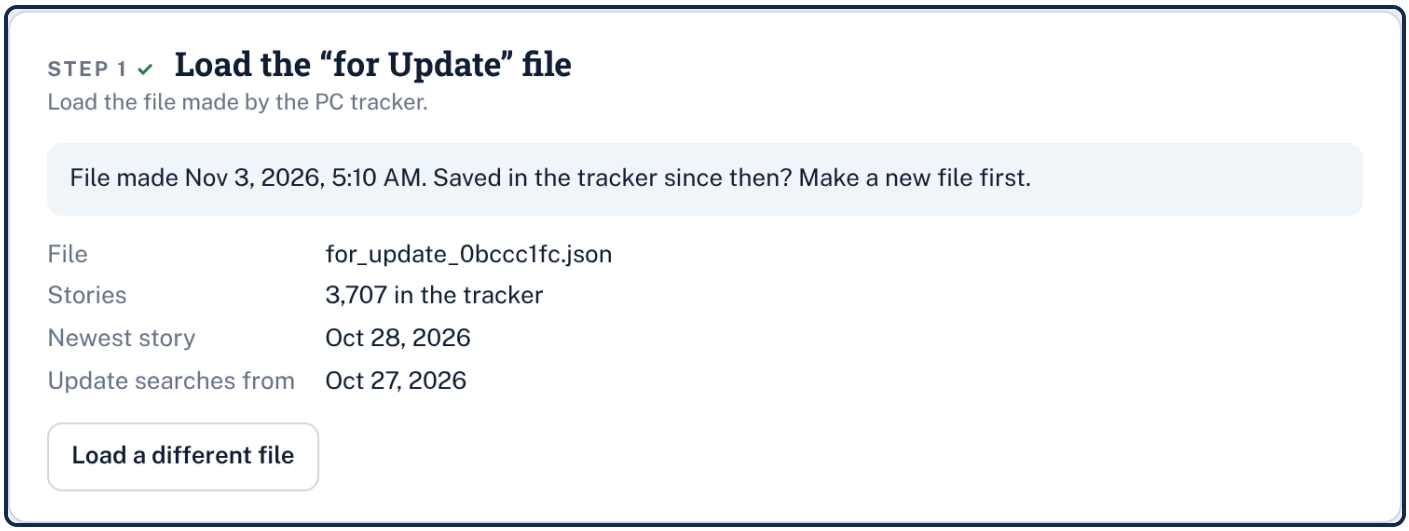
STEP 2 · IN THE UPDATE STATION

Open the station and load the file

1. Open the Update station in your browser: https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL. Sign in to claude.ai if asked.
2. In **Step 1**, drop the “for Update” file on the dashed box, or click the box and choose the file from Downloads.
3. Check what the station read from it: the file name, the number of stories, the **newest story**, and **Update searches from**. The search starts the day before the newest story, so there is no date to pick.



Step 1 before a file is loaded.



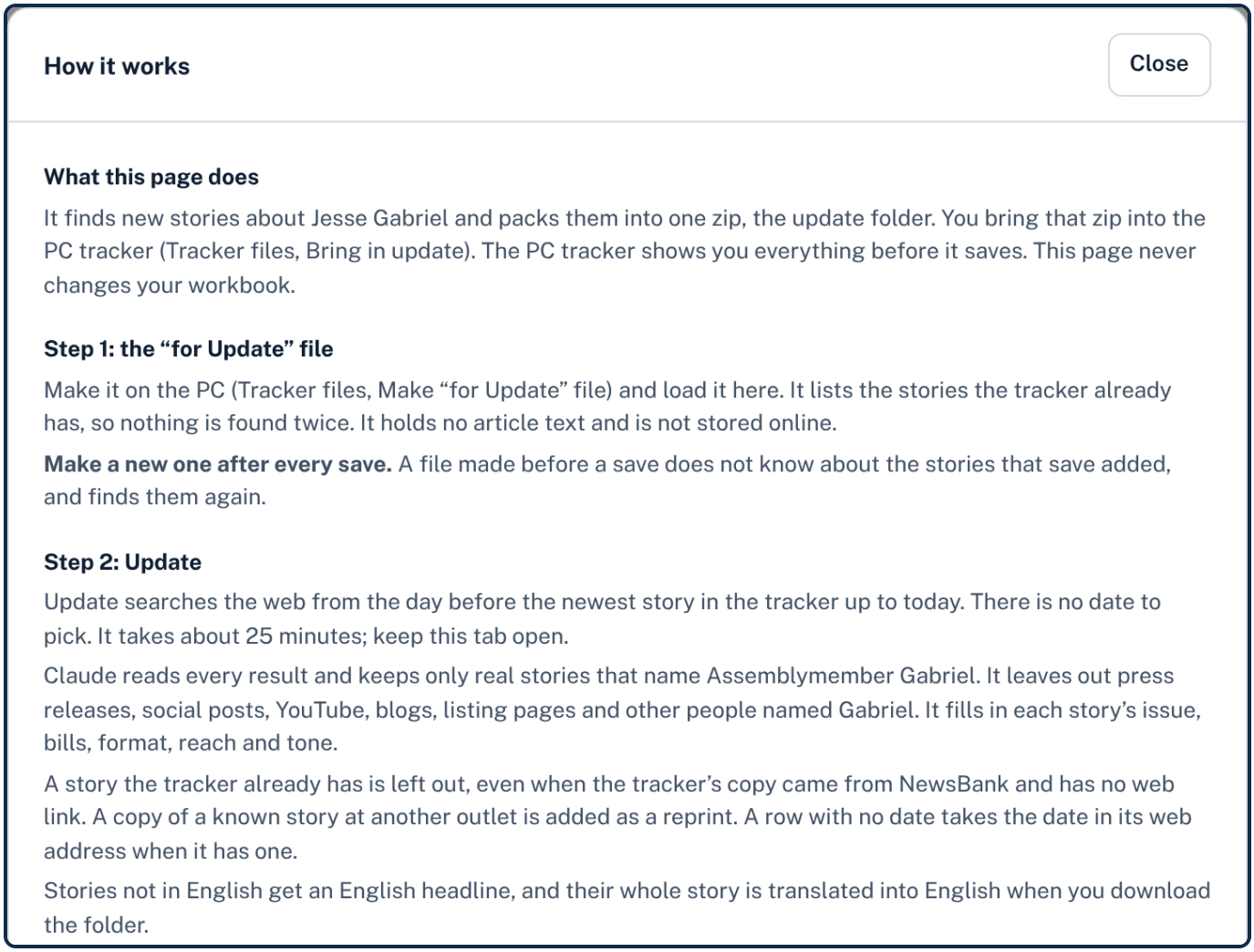
Step 1 after loading. The gray line says when the file was made; if you saved in the tracker since then, make a new file first.

How it works

The top of the station has two buttons. **How it works** opens the station's own short explanation of every part. **Update database** starts the search (the same as the button in Step 2 on the page).



The top of the Update station: 1 How it works, 2 Update database.

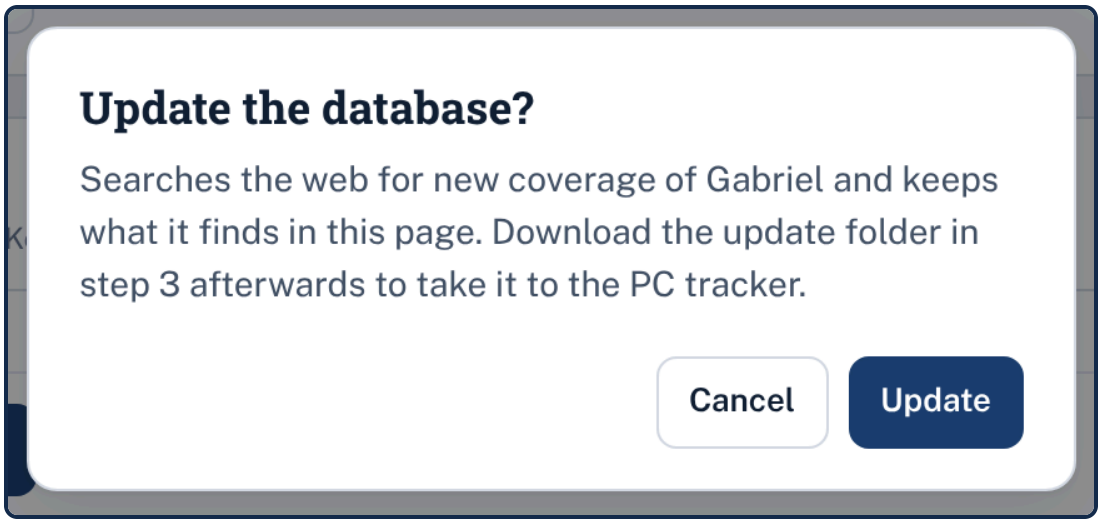


The top of the How it works window. It goes on to cover NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, downloading, Automatic mode and what to do if something is blocked. Close returns to the page.

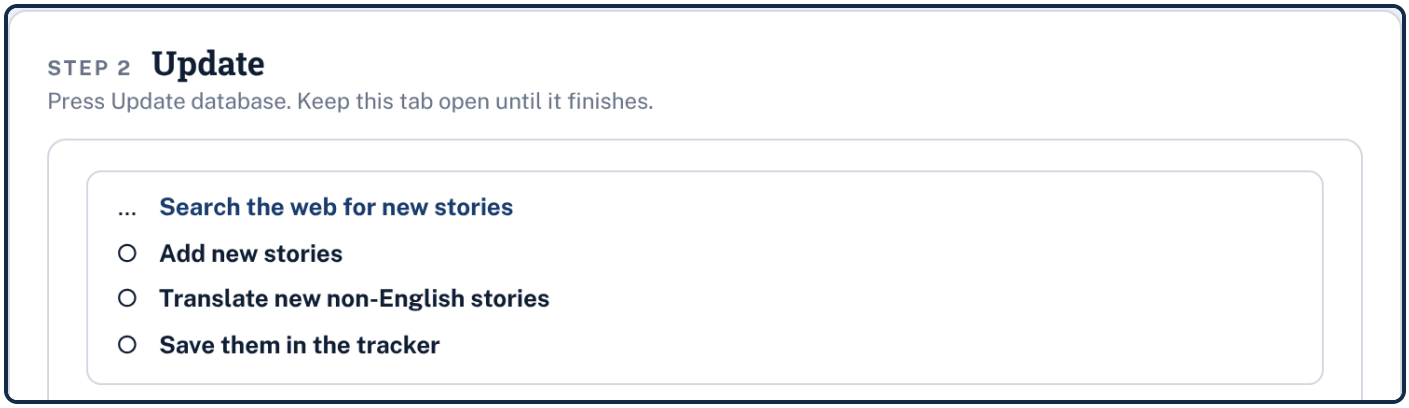
STEP 3 · IN THE UPDATE STATION

Press Update database

1. Press **Update database**. A box asks you to confirm; press **Update**.
2. **Keep the tab open** and in front until it finishes. It takes about 25 minutes. Browsers slow down tabs in the background, which can stall the run. You can use other programs; just don't close the tab.
3. Watch the checklist. Each line gets a check mark when it is done: search the web, add new stories, translate non-English stories, keep them for the update folder.



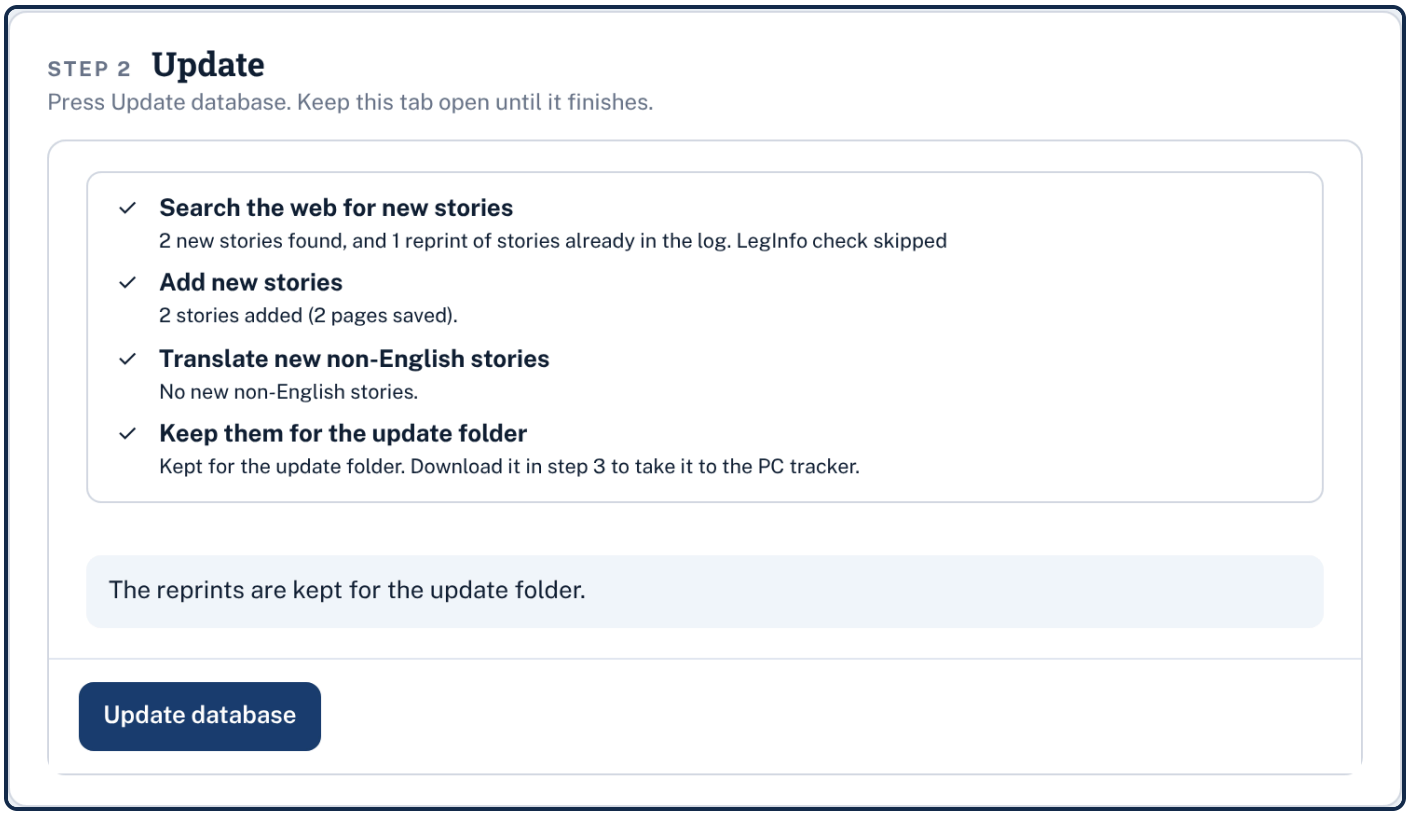
The confirm box.



While it runs: the line in blue is the one being worked on. Stop ends the run early.

STEP 3, CONTINUED

When the run is done



A finished run (a test run with made-up stories). Each line says what it found.

What the search does for you

- Claude reads every result and keeps only real news stories that name Assemblymember Gabriel. It leaves out press releases, social posts, YouTube, blogs, listing pages and other people named Gabriel.
- It fills in each story's issue, bills, format, reach and tone.
- A story the tracker already has is left out. A copy of a known story at another outlet is added as a **reprint** of it.
- Stories not in English get an English headline. The whole story is translated into English when you download the folder.

IF THE RUN ENDS EARLY

A red note says so. It does not mean "nothing new". Press Update database again, or download what it found and run it again another time.

STEP 4 · OPTIONAL

Add NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs

About 1 in 6 stories (print, wire stories, paywalled papers) can't be found on the web. About once a month, and soon after big events like the budget vote, add them from NewsBank. ProQuest PDFs work the same way in their own box.

1. **Download the PDFs.** Follow the **NewsBank Download Guide** (a separate printed guide). It explains the saved search, the date ranges and how to download each page of results as one PDF with APA citations. It says to start one week before the newest story in the tracker; the station shows that date in Step 1 as **Newest story**. Where the station's short How it works text differs (it says to sort newest first), follow the Download Guide.
2. **Drop the PDFs** on the box **Add NewsBank PDFs and newspaper pages** (or **Add ProQuest PDFs**). You can drop many at once. A PDF can hold any number of stories.
3. With **Automatic mode** on (Step 3 on the page, on by default), they are added by themselves. If it is off, check the list and press **Add to the update**.



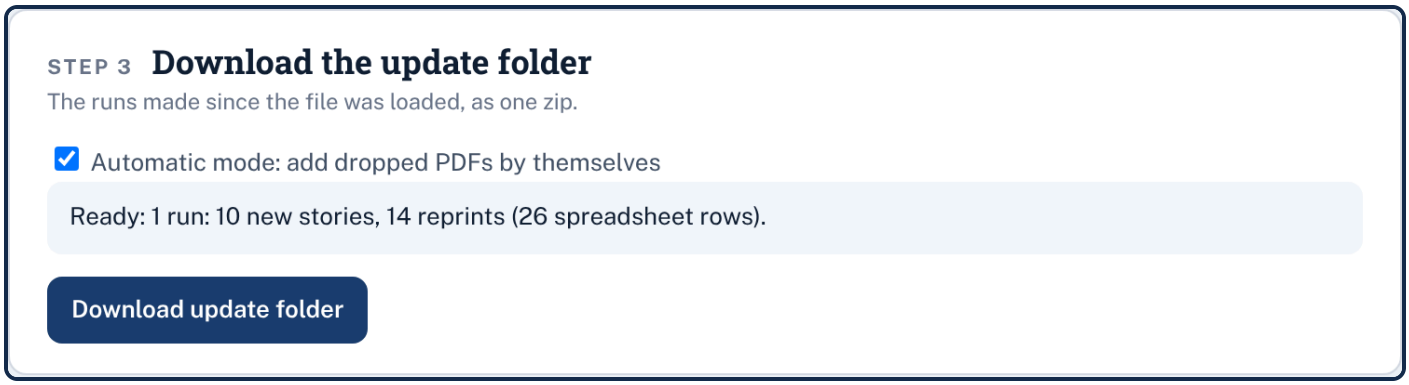
The NewsBank box. It also takes a picture or PDF of any newspaper page. The ProQuest box below it looks the same.

- The station splits each NewsBank PDF into one PDF per story and skips stories the tracker already has.
- A NewsBank "Full Page" is a picture of a newspaper page. Claude reads it and adds the article about him to the right story, or as a new story. A page it can't place goes to "Unlinked print pages" in the workbook.
- If a run is going, the PDFs wait for it to finish.

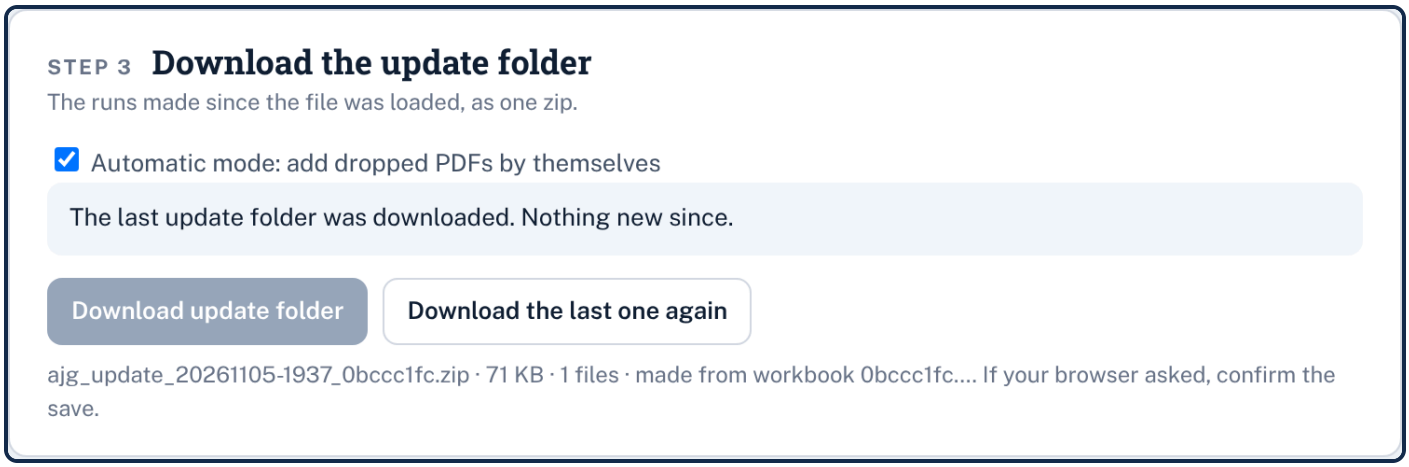
STEP 5 · IN THE UPDATE STATION

Download the update folder

1. When the run (and any PDFs) are done, Step 3 on the page says what is ready, for example “Ready: 1 run: 10 new stories, 14 reprints”.
2. Press **Download update folder**. It saves one .zip to your Downloads folder, named like `ajg_update_20261105-1937_0bccc1fc.zip`. If your browser asks, confirm the save.
3. If you add more after downloading, download again. The new folder has everything and replaces the old one; it ends in `_v2`. Bring in only the newest one.



Ready to download.



Downloaded. “Download the last one again” is there if the file went missing.

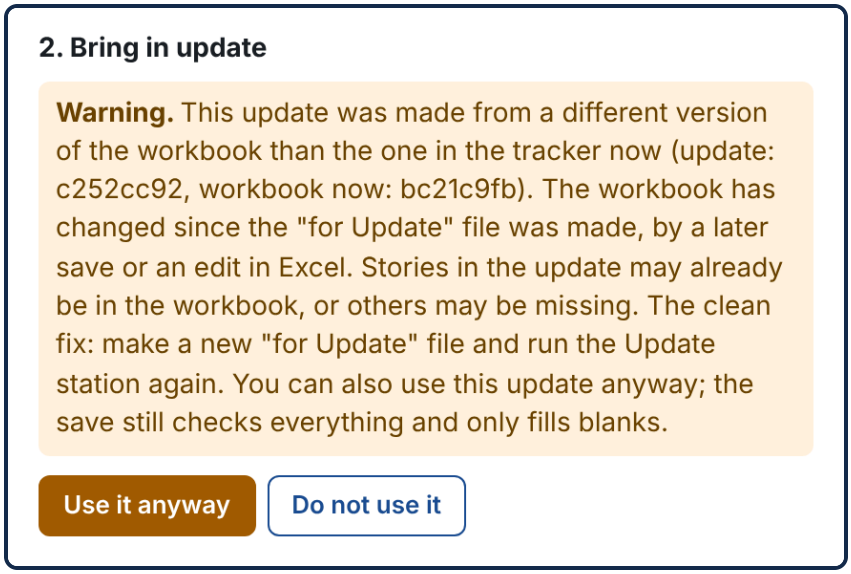
DON’T UNZIP IT

Keep the .zip as it is. The PC tracker takes the .zip file itself.

STEP 6 · ON THE PC

Bring in the update and save

1. Close Excel. In the tracker, click **Tracker files**.
2. Drop the update zip on the dashed box under **2. Bring in update**, or click **choose a file**.
3. Wait for the preview. Nothing is saved yet. It can take a few minutes.
4. If you see a **warning** that the update was made from a different version of the workbook, the workbook changed after you made the “for Update” file. The clean fix is a new “for Update” file and a new run. **Use it anyway** also works: the save still checks everything and only fills blanks.



The warning for an update made from an older workbook.

Read the preview

2. Bring in update

If you press Save: 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 conflicts left for Sammy, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

You chose to use an update made from an older workbook. The save still runs all its checks.

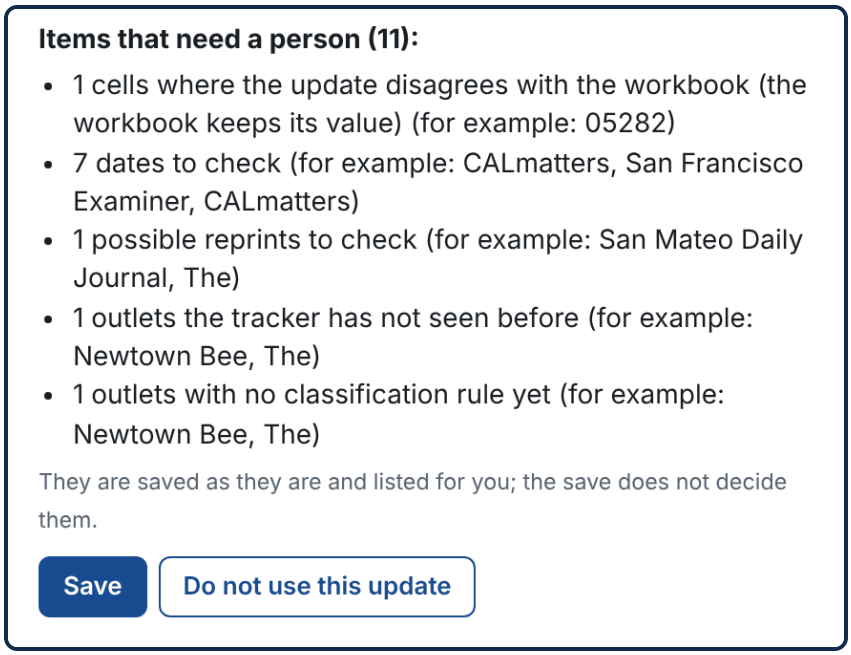
- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888); 1 story edited (s01674; fields: outlet)
- 1 edit will not be applied, because the workbook already has a different value in that cell and the workbook keeps its own (story s01674). They stay in this tracker, marked as reported.
- 21 rows added to the Coverage tab
- 10 rows added to the Originals tab
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 rows added to the Unlinked print pages tab
- 4 reprint counts updated
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 2 press-release cells recalculated
- 25 saved pages added to the library
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)
- The update carries 1 run, 5 reprints
- 11 file(s) renamed to the names the save gave (11

The top of the preview: what Save would do. (A long list of renamed files under it is left out here.)

- **The bold line** sums up what Save would do: rows added, cells filled, reprints, and your own waiting edits.
- The tracker compares the article texts to make the final call on what is a reprint, and gives the new files their final numbers. The preview lists every change.

STEP 6, CONTINUED

Items that need a person, then Save



The end of the preview: items that need a person, then Save.

Items that need a person are things the save won't decide for you, such as a date to check, a possible reprint, or an outlet the tracker hasn't seen before. They are saved as they are and listed for you; check them afterwards and fix any with Edit details.

1. Press **Save**, or **Do not use this update** to drop it.
2. Keep the black window open. The tracker backs up the workbook, writes, then reloads the page by itself.

STEP 6, CONTINUED

After the save

2. Bring in update

Saved. 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 conflicts left for Sammy, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

- Backup of the old workbook: AJG Coverage - NewsBank BACKUP before run run-mw3o2qv2rzz 2026-11-05 1139.xlsx
- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1

- 0 file name(s) were as the station named them.
- 1 edit saved and set aside in the tracker (db_applied\edits, not deleted)
- New workbook fingerprint: d2d774e5
- The tracker page was rebuilt with the new stories
- 11 items are listed for a person to look at (see the run notes)

Reloading the tracker...

The result of a save (the middle of the list is left out here). It names the backup and the new workbook fingerprint.

The new stories are now in the tracker. The line at the top of the page says “Last updated” with today’s date, and the Update log in Manage lists the update with everything it added.

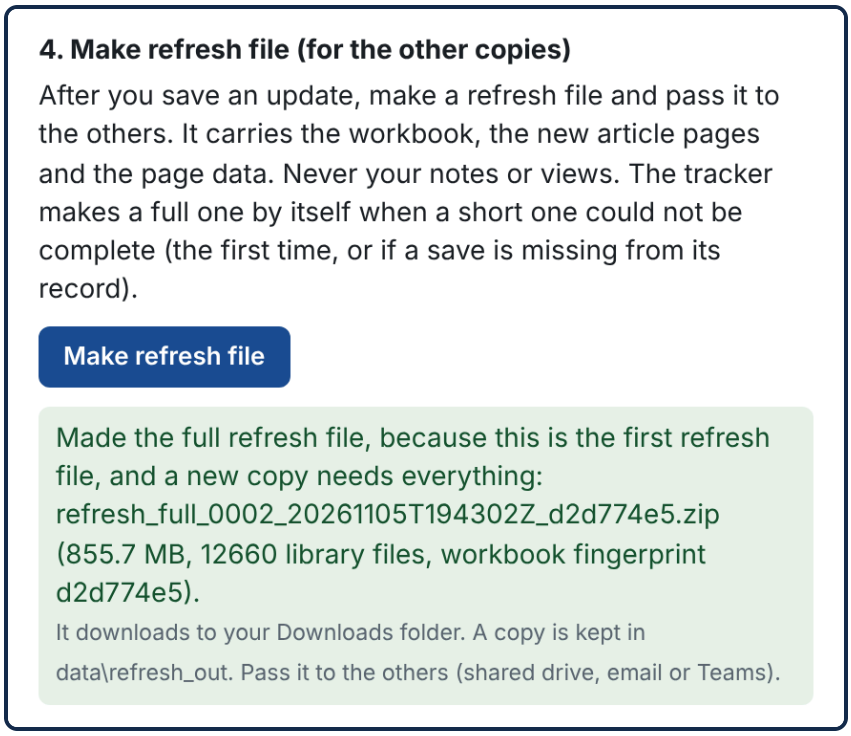
NEXT TIME, A NEW “FOR UPDATE” FILE

The save changed the workbook. Before the next Update station run, make a new “for Update” file (Step 1).

STEP 7 · ON THE PC

Make refresh files for colleagues

1. In **Tracker files**, under **4. Make refresh file**, click **Make refresh file**.
2. It downloads to your Downloads folder.
3. Pass it to your colleagues by the shared drive, email or Teams.
4. Each colleague opens their own tracker, clicks **Tracker files**, and drops the file on **Bring in refresh file**. Their notes and saved views stay as they are.



The refresh file was made. The first one is a full one with everything, so it is large; later ones carry only what changed.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
“Claude is not allowed on this page”	Allow Claude for the station page in the Permissions menu, including sending pictures, then reload the page.
The search finds nothing or stops at once	TinyFish must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) and allowed for the station page.
“File made … Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.”	If you saved in the tracker after making the file, make a new “for Update” file and load that one.
A red note says the run ended early	It does not mean nothing new. Run Update database again.
You closed the station tab during a run	The run stops. Load the “for Update” file again and press Update database again.
You added PDFs after downloading	Download again. Bring in only the newest zip (the one ending _v2, _v3 …).
The PC warns the update was made from a different workbook	Make a new “for Update” file and run the station again, or press Use it anyway.
The PC says the update was already saved	You brought in a zip that was saved before. Nothing is added twice. Use the newest zip, or make a new “for Update” file and run again.
Save is grayed out	Close Excel, and wait for any other save to finish. If the workbook was changed in Excel, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”.
“That is not a .zip file”	Drop the .zip itself, not an unzipped folder.

CHEAT SHEET

Start to finish

On the PC

1. Tracker files → **Make “for Update” file**.
2. (After the station) Tracker files → **Bring in update** → drop the zip.
3. Read the preview and the items that need a person → **Save**.
4. **Make refresh file** → pass it on.

In the Update station

1. Open the station; drop the “for Update” file in Step 1.
2. Check **Update searches from**.
3. **Update database** → Update. Keep the tab open (about 25 minutes).
4. Optional: drop NewsBank / ProQuest PDFs.
5. **Download update folder**.

REMEMBER

Make a new “for Update” file after every save. Bring in only the newest zip. Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC.